

We plow the fields and scatter

Text: Matthias Claudius, 1782
tr. Jane M. Campbell, 1861, alt.
WIR PFLÜGEN 76.76 D with refrain

Music: Johann A. P. Schulz, 1800

The musical score is written for a single voice part in treble clef, 4/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a clear refrain at the end. The lyrics are arranged in three columns, corresponding to the three parts of the hymn. The first part (1) is the main melody, the second part (2) is a harmony, and the third part (3) is a counter-melody. The score is divided into six systems, each with a musical staff and three columns of lyrics. The first system starts with a treble clef and a key signature of three flats. The second system has a key signature change to two flats (B-flat, E-flat). The third system has a key signature change to one flat (B-flat). The fourth system has a key signature change to no flats (C major). The fifth system has a key signature change to one flat (B-flat). The sixth system has a key signature change to two flats (B-flat, E-flat). The score ends with a double bar line.

1 We plow the fields and scat - ter the good seed on the land,
2 You on - ly are the Mak - er of all things near and far.
3 We thank you, then, Cre - a - tor, for all things bright and good,
but it is fed and wa - tered by God's al - might - y hand.
You paint the way - side flow - er, you light the eve - ning star.
the seed-time, and the har - vest, our life, our health, our food.
God sends the snow in win - ter, the warmth to swell the grain,
The winds and waves o - bey you, by you the birds are fed;
Ac - cept the gifts we of - fer for all your love im - parts,
the breez - es, and the sun - shine, and soft re - fresh - ing rain.
much more to us, your chil - dren, you give our da - ly bread.
and what you most would wel - come: our hum - ble thank - ful hearts.
All good gifts a - round us are sent from heav'n a - bove.
We thank you, God, we thank you, God, for all your love.